

RP01

Governor of Rajasthan

About 2-3 questions a paper. Rajasthan Polity now scores higher than Indian Polity, and the Governor is its single most reliable chapter. Rajpramukh-to-Governor was asked in 2023 and again in 2024.

The Governor is where Rajasthan Polity begins, and RPSC keeps coming back to two things — how the office grew out of the Rajpramukh, and the list of Governors with its firsts and records. Learn the office as a set of Articles, then learn the names as a table.

Governor of Rajasthan

Evolution

- Rajpramukh 1948-56
- Man Singh II last Rajpramukh
- 7th Amendment 1956
- Governor from 1 Nov 1956

Office

- Art 153 office
- Art 155 appointed by President
- Art 156 pleasure, 5 years
- Art 157 age 35
- Art 159 oath by CJ of Raj HC

Powers

- Executive - 154, 164, 165
- Legislative - 174, 175, 176, 200, 201, 213
- Financial - 202, 203, 207
- Judicial - 161
- Discretionary - 163(2), 356

Firsts

- Gurmukh Nihal Singh first
- Pratibha Patil first woman
- Longest - Gurmukh Nihal Singh
- Jagat Narain first acting

Article 356

- Four spells
- 1967, 1977, 1980, 1992-93
- 1992-93 longest, 354 days

Other hats

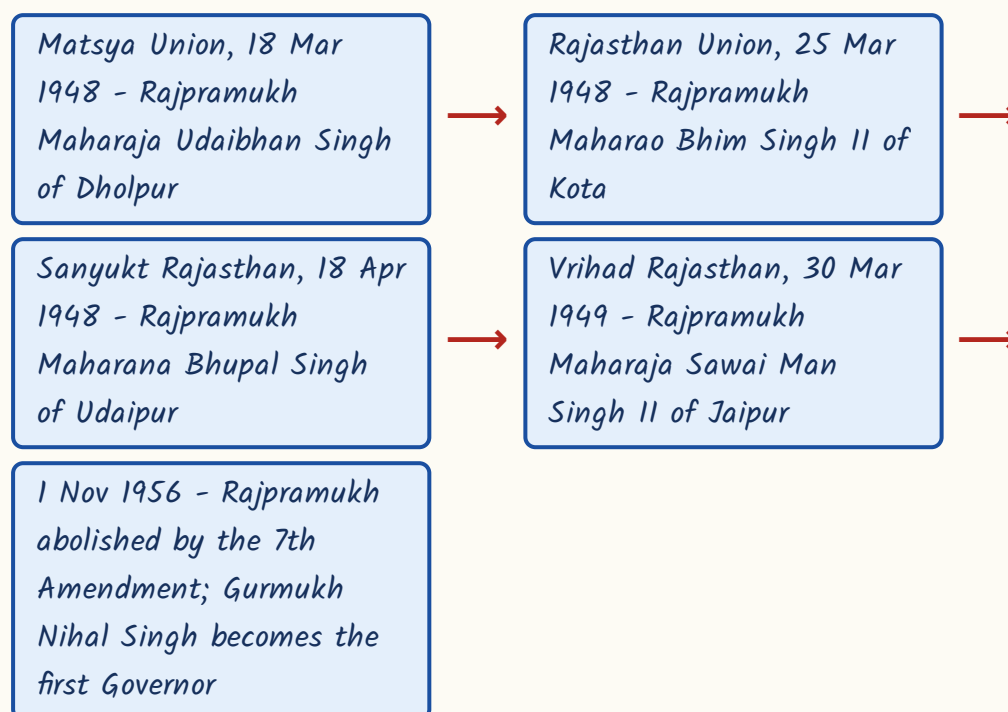
- Chancellor of State universities
- Appoints AG, RPSC, SEC, Lokayukta
- Art 361 immunity

From Rajpramukh to Governor - do this first

Rajasthan was not born as one state. It was welded together in stages between 1948 and 1956 out of princely states. Each stage had a constitutional head called the Rajpramukh. A Rajpramukh was a ruling prince - a Maharaja - made head of the new union. He was not appointed by anybody in Delhi in the way a Governor is; he came with a throne already.

When the States Reorganisation Act came into force on 1 November 1956, this arrangement ended. The Seventh Constitutional Amendment Act, 1956 abolished the post of Rajpramukh and put a Governor in its place - appointed by the President, holding office at the President's pleasure. The same Amendment also allowed one person to be Governor of two or more States. Learn that sentence. RPSC asked it in 2023 and again in 2024.

The chain of headship, 1948 to 1956



Union to Rajpramukh - the classic match-the-following

Union	Formed	Rajpramukh
Matsya Union	18 March 1948	Maharaja Udaibhan Singh, Dholpur
Rajasthan Union	25 March 1948	Maharao Bhim Singh II, Kota
Sanyukt Rajasthan	18 April 1948	Maharana Bhupal Singh, Udaipur

Union	Formed	Rajpramukh
Vrihad Rajasthan	30 March 1949	Maharaja Sawai Man Singh II, Jaipur

The four Rajpramukhs and their princely seats



Dholpur 18 Mar 1948, Kota 25 Mar 1948, Udaipur 18 Apr 1948, Jaipur 30 Mar 1949

- Sawai Man Singh II held the office from 30 March 1949 to 31 October 1956 - the last Rajpramukh of Rajasthan.
- Maharana Bhupal Singh of Udaipur was elevated as Maharajpramukh when Vrihad Rajasthan was formed.
- The Rajpramukh's office ended on 31 October 1956; the Governor's began the next day, 1 November 1956.

Rajpramukh vs Governor - the difference RPSC tests

Rajpramukh (1948-1956)	Governor (from 1 Nov 1956)
A ruling prince of a covenanting state	Any Indian citizen aged 35 or above
Chosen under the covenant of the merging states	Appointed by the President under Article 155
Held office by virtue of the covenant	Holds office during the President's pleasure, Article 156
Post abolished by the 7th Amendment, 1956	Continues; one person may head two or more States

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - by which Constitutional Amendment Act was the post of Rajpramukh abolished? Answer: the Seventh Amendment Act, 1956.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - who was the Rajpramukh of Vrihad Rajasthan formed on 30 March 1949? Answer: Maharaja Sawai Man Singh II of Jaipur.

YAAD RAKHO

Trick to remember the four Rajpramukhs - D-K-U-J: Dholpur, Kota, Udaipur, Jaipur, in that order. The dates run 18 Mar, 25 Mar, 18 Apr 1948, then 30 Mar 1949.

The office - appointment, qualification, term, removal

Now the constitutional frame. Article 153 says there shall be a Governor for each State. Article 154 vests the executive power of the State in him - he exercises it himself or through officers subordinate to him. That is the whole legal basis of the state government acting in his name.

The Articles you must be able to match

Article	Subject
153	There shall be a Governor for each State
154	Executive power of the State vested in the Governor
155	Appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal
156	Holds office during the President's pleasure; normal term five years
157	Qualifications - citizen of India, completed 35 years of age
158	Conditions of office - no office of profit, not an MP or MLA
159	Oath of office
161	Pardoning power
163	Council of Ministers to aid and advise
164	Appointment of Chief Minister and Ministers
165	Advocate General of the State
166	Conduct of business of the State Government
167	Duties of the Chief Minister towards the Governor
361	Immunity from court proceedings during the term

- The oath is administered by the Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court, or in his absence the senior-most available judge of that Court - Article 159.
- If a sitting MP or MLA is appointed Governor, that seat falls vacant on the day he enters office.
- Emoluments and allowances are charged on the Consolidated Fund of the State and cannot be diminished during his term.
- There is no impeachment for a Governor. He can resign, be transferred, or simply be asked to go - the President's pleasure has no stated procedure.
- Article 361 gives him immunity from court proceedings for anything done in the exercise of his office, during his term.

TRAP

The Rajasthan Legislative Assembly cannot remove the Governor. There is no resolution, no address, no impeachment at state level. RPSC puts this in NOT-correct questions - do not confuse the Governor with the President, who is impeachable under Article 61.

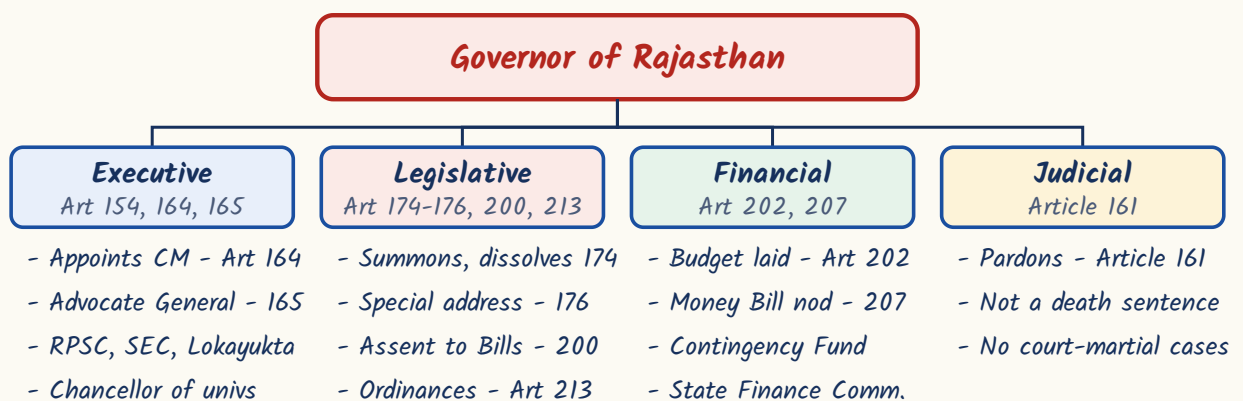
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre style repeatedly - who administers the oath to the Governor of Rajasthan? Answer: the Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court. Not the President, not the Chief Justice of India.

Executive powers - and the appointments he signs

Every executive act of the Government of Rajasthan is taken in the Governor's name under Article 166. In practice he acts on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers under Article 163. But the appointment letters carry his signature, and RPSC asks who he appoints.

The Governor's powers, grouped



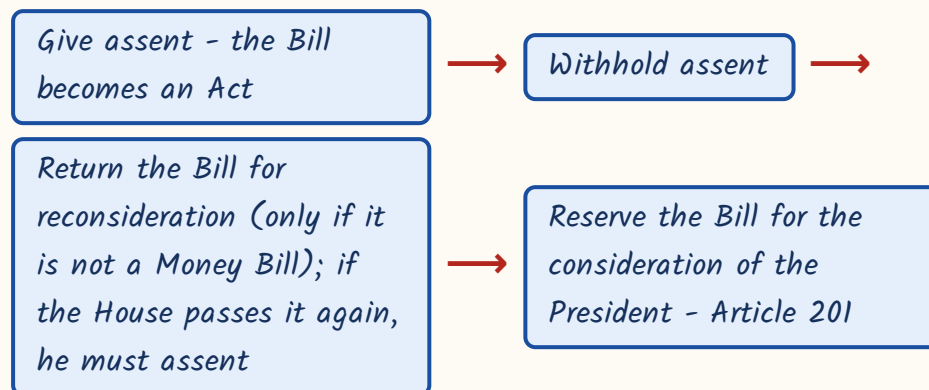
- Appoints the Chief Minister, and the other Ministers on the Chief Minister's advice - Article 164.
- Appoints the Advocate General of Rajasthan - Article 165 - who holds office during his pleasure.
- Appoints the Chairman and members of the Rajasthan Public Service Commission - Article 316 - but only the President can remove them.
- Appoints the Rajasthan State Election Commissioner under Article 243K.
- Appoints the Lokayukta and Up-Lokayukta of Rajasthan, and the Chairperson and members of the Rajasthan State Human Rights Commission.
- Is ex-officio Chancellor of the State universities of Rajasthan - a statutory function under the university statutes, not a constitutional one.
- Is consulted by the President in the appointment of judges of the Rajasthan High Court.
- Administers Scheduled Areas and can direct that an Act of Parliament or the State Legislature shall not apply, or apply with modifications, in those areas.

Legislative powers - summoning, assent, ordinance

The Governor is a part of the State Legislature even though he never sits in it. Nothing becomes law in Rajasthan without his assent. Group these Articles together and revise them as one block.

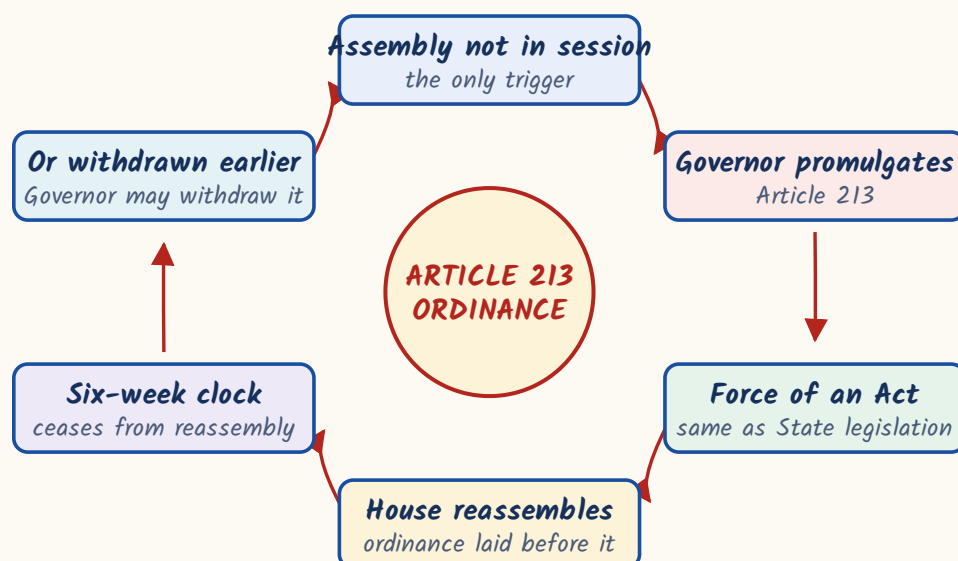
- Article 174 - summons the House, prorogues it, and dissolves the Assembly. The gap between two sessions cannot exceed six months.
- Article 175 - may address the House and send messages to it.
- Article 176 - the special address at the first session after each general election and at the first session of every year.
- Article 200 - assent to Bills. Four choices, given below.
- Article 201 - a Bill reserved for the President; the President may assent, withhold, or direct the Governor to return it to the House.
- Article 213 - ordinances when the Assembly is not in session.
- Nominates one member of the Anglo-Indian community was a power once available under Article 333; it lapsed with the 104th Amendment, 2019.

Article 200 - what the Governor may do with a Bill sent to him



- An ordinance under Article 213 can be issued only when the Assembly is not in session.
- It has the same force as an Act of the Legislature.
- It must be laid before the Legislature and ceases to operate six weeks from the date of reassembly, unless disapproved earlier.
- In specified cases the Governor must first obtain instructions from the President - where a Bill with the same provisions would have needed the President's prior sanction or reservation.
- He may withdraw an ordinance at any time.

Life of an ordinance under Article 213



TRAP

A Money Bill cannot be returned for reconsideration. Even for other Bills, the House is not bound to accept the Governor's suggestions - it may pass the Bill unchanged and he must then assent. Statement III of the 2023-pattern question is built on this.

Financial and judicial powers

Financial powers are short but they get asked as one-liners. The Governor controls the money door of the Assembly - no demand for a grant and no Money Bill can go in without his recommendation.

- A Money Bill can be introduced in the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly only on the Governor's recommendation - Article 207.
- He causes the annual financial statement, the state budget, to be laid before the House - Article 202.
- No demand for a grant can be made except on his recommendation.
- He can make advances out of the Contingency Fund of Rajasthan to meet unforeseen expenditure.
- He constitutes a State Finance Commission every five years to review the finances of panchayats and municipalities - Article 243-I and 243Y.

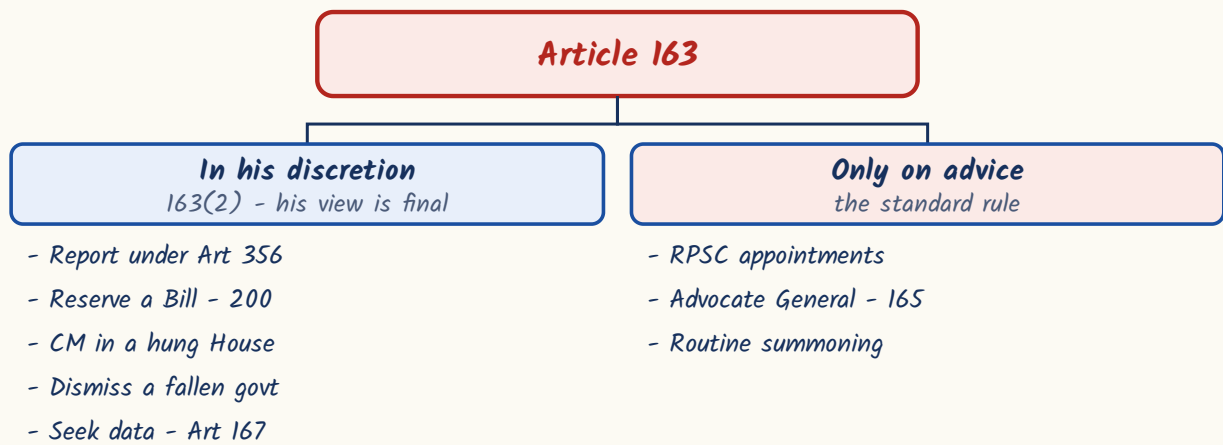
Pardoning power - President (Art 72) vs Governor (Art 161)

President - Article 72	Governor - Article 161
Pardon, reprieve, respite, remission, suspension, commutation	The same five, for offences against laws on State subjects
Can pardon a death sentence	Cannot pardon a death sentence - he may only suspend, remit or commute it
Can deal with court-martial sentences	Has no power at all over court-martial sentences
Extends to Union law offences everywhere	Limited to matters in the State's executive power

Discretionary powers - the examiner's favourite corner

A Governor normally acts on ministerial advice. But the Constitution keeps a small pocket of situations where he decides on his own. Article 163(2) then says something powerful - if a question arises whether a matter falls in his discretion, his own decision is final, and the validity of what he did cannot be called into question on the ground that he ought not to have acted in his discretion. Courts stay out of that question.

Discretion and advice - Article 163



- Recommending President's Rule to the President under Article 356.
 - Reserving a Bill for the consideration of the President under Article 200.
 - Appointing the Chief Minister when no party has a clear majority, or when a Chief Minister dies in office without an obvious successor.
 - Dismissing a Council of Ministers that has lost the confidence of the House and refuses to resign.
 - Dissolving the Assembly when the ministry has lost its majority.
 - Seeking information from the Chief Minister under Article 167.
 - Functions as administrator of an adjoining Union Territory, where so appointed.
-
- NOT discretionary - appointing the Chairman and members of the RPSC. He does that on ministerial advice.
 - NOT discretionary - appointing the Advocate General under Article 165; that too is on advice.
 - NOT discretionary - the routine summoning and proroguing of the House.

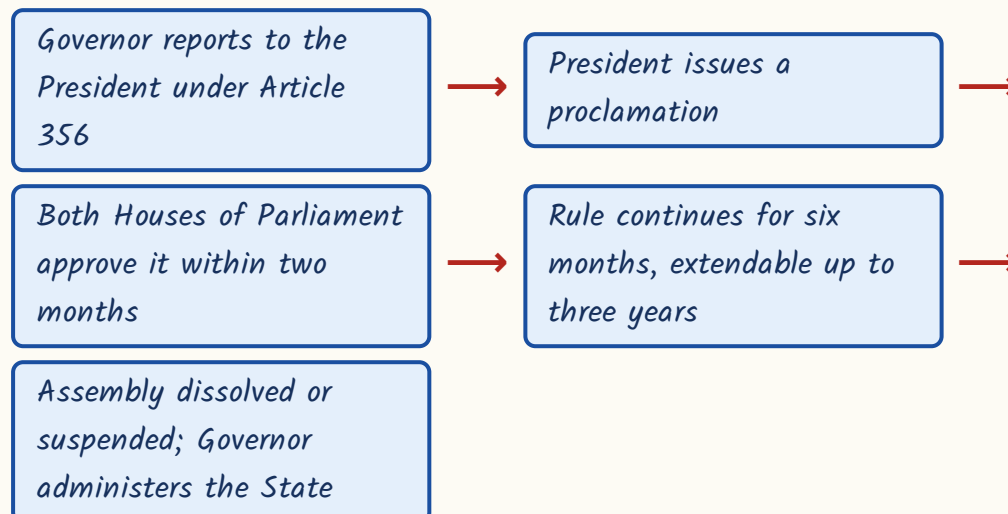
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 in the NOT-correct format - which is NOT a discretionary power of the Governor of Rajasthan? Answer: appointing the Chairman of the Rajasthan Public Service Commission.

Article 356 and President's Rule in Rajasthan

Article 356 lets the President take over a State when its government cannot be carried on in accordance with the Constitution. The trigger is usually a report from the Governor. During President's Rule the Assembly is either dissolved or kept in suspended animation, and the State is administered by the Governor on the President's behalf.

How a State goes under President's Rule



Rajasthan has been under President's Rule four times. Learn the four years, and learn whose government fell each time - RPSC has asked this in 2013, in 2016 and again in 2024, in one-liner form and in match form.

President's Rule in Rajasthan - all four spells

Spell	Dates	Government displaced
First	13 March to 26 April 1967	Mohan Lal Sukhadia
Second	30 April to 21 June 1977	Hari Dev Joshi
Third	17 February to 5 June 1980	Bhairon Singh Shekhawat (first time)
Fourth	15 December 1992 to 3 December 1993	Bhairon Singh Shekhawat (second time)

- Bhairon Singh Shekhawat is the Chief Minister whose government was dismissed most often - twice, in 1980 and in 1992-93.
- The 1992-93 spell, imposed after the Babri Masjid demolition, ran about 354 days - the longest of the four.
- The 1967 spell followed a hung Assembly after the fourth general election.
- After the S.R. Bommai judgment of 1994, a proclamation under Article 356 is subject to judicial review and a majority must be tested on the floor of the House.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - how many times has President's Rule been imposed in Rajasthan? Answer: four. The companion statement question adds that Shekhawat's government was displaced twice.

YAAD RAKHO

Remember the four years as a rhythm - 67, 77, 80, 92. Two of them, 80 and 92, are Shekhawat's.

The Governors of Rajasthan - the list and the firsts

This is pure memory work and it pays. RPSC asks the firsts, the records, one odd-man-out from the list, and a chronological ordering question. Read the two tables below as one continuous line, then read the firsts.

Governors of Rajasthan, 1956 to 1990 (regular incumbents)

Governor	Tenure	Known for
Gurmukh Nihal Singh	1 Nov 1956 - 16 Apr 1962	First Governor; earlier Chief Minister of Delhi
Dr Sampurnanand	16 Apr 1962 - 16 Apr 1967	Former Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh
Sardar Hukam Singh	1967-1970 and 1970-1972	Former Speaker of the Lok Sabha
Jogendra Singh	1972-1977	
Raghukul Tilak	1977-1981	
Air Chief Marshal O.P. Mehra	1982-1985	Only former Chief of the Air Staff to hold the post
Vasantdada Patil	1985-1987	Former Chief Minister of Maharashtra
Sukhdev Prasad	1988-1990	

Governors of Rajasthan, 1990 to the present

Governor	Tenure	Known for
Debi Prasad Chattopadhyaya	1990-1991	
Marri Chenna Reddy	1992-1993	
Bali Ram Bhagat	1993-1998	Former Speaker of the Lok Sabha and External Affairs Minister
Darbara Singh	1998	Died in office
Justice Anshuman Singh	1999-2003	
Nirmal Chandra Jain	2003	Died in office
Madan Lal Khurana	2004	Former Chief Minister of Delhi

Governor	Tenure	Known for
Pratibha Patil	8 Nov 2004 - 23 Jun 2007	First woman Governor; later President of India
Shailendra Kumar Singh	2007-2009	
Prabha Rau	2009-2010	Died in office
Margaret Alva	2012-2014	Third woman Governor
Kalyan Singh	2014-2019	Former Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh
Kalraj Mishra	2019-2024	Governor during the 2020 political crisis
Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde	31 July 2024 onwards	Former Speaker, Maharashtra Assembly

- First Governor - Gurmukh Nihal Singh, from 1 November 1956.
- Longest tenure - Gurmukh Nihal Singh, 5 years 166 days. Kalraj Mishra is second at about 4 years 326 days.
- First woman Governor - Pratibha Patil; she resigned in June 2007 to contest, and win, the office of President of India.
- Women Governors of Rajasthan, in order - Pratibha Patil (2004-07), Prabha Rau (2009-10), Margaret Alva (2012-14).
- First acting Governor - Justice Jagat Narain, November-December 1970.
- Justice Jagdish Sharan Verma was acting Governor in 1987-88 and again in 1989, and later became Chief Justice of India.
- Governors who died in office - Darbara Singh (1998), Nirmal Chandra Jain (2003) and Prabha Rau (2010).

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - who was the first Governor of Rajasthan?

Answer: Gurmukh Nihal Singh. The same paper carried a NOT-correctly-matched question whose wrong pair was 'longest tenure - Kalraj Mishra'.

TRAP

Longest tenure is Gurmukh Nihal Singh, not Kalraj Mishra and not Kalyan Singh. Kalyan Singh and Sampurnanand each completed almost exactly five years, which is why they are used as distractors.

Governor and Chief Minister – friction, and the current position

The Governor's discretion becomes visible only in a crisis. Rajasthan's most recent example is July-August 2020, when a group of Congress MLAs revolted against Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot. The Chief Minister asked Governor Kalraj Mishra to summon the Assembly; the Governor initially sought clarifications and set conditions before issuing the summons. The session was eventually called and Gehlot won a confidence motion by voice vote on 14 August 2020.

- Article 174 gives the Governor the power to summon, but the settled position is that he acts on the advice of the Council of Ministers in summoning the House.
- The floor of the House, not the Raj Bhavan, is the place to test a majority – the rule laid down in *S.R. Bommai (1994)*.
- Article 167 lets the Governor call for information from the Chief Minister; in 2020 this Article was much discussed.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the Governor of Rajasthan is Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde, sworn in on 31 July 2024, succeeding Kalraj Mishra. He was earlier Speaker of the Maharashtra Legislative Assembly. Any change of Governor before December 2026 is a certain current-affairs question – check the Raj Bhavan Rajasthan website in the last month before the exam.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the assent power under Article 200 has been the biggest constitutional story of the last two years, and it applies to the Governor of Rajasthan exactly as it does elsewhere. In April 2025 the Supreme Court, deciding the Tamil Nadu Governor's case, fixed time limits for a Governor and for the President to act on Bills and treated ten pending Bills as deemed to have been assented. The President then made a Reference under Article 143, and on 20 November 2025 a five-judge Constitution Bench gave its opinion - courts cannot prescribe a timeline for the Governor or the President under Articles 200 and 201, and there is no such thing as deemed assent, although prolonged inaction can still be challenged in court. Expect a statement question built on Article 200 in 2026.

REVISION RECAP

1. Article 153 Governor for each State; 154 executive power; 155 appointed by the President; 156 pleasure, five-year term.
2. Article 157 - citizen of India, 35 years of age. Article 158 - no office of profit, not an MP or MLA.
3. Oath under Article 159 is administered by the Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court.
4. Emoluments charged on the Consolidated Fund of the State; cannot be reduced during the term.
5. Rajpramukhs in order - Dholpur (Matsya), Kota (Rajasthan Union), Udaipur (Sanyukt), Jaipur (Vrihad).
6. Sawai Man Singh II, Rajpramukh 30 Mar 1949 to 31 Oct 1956, was the last Rajpramukh.
7. Seventh Amendment Act 1956 abolished the Rajpramukh and allowed one Governor for two or more States.
8. Gurmukh Nihal Singh - first Governor, 1 Nov 1956, longest tenure at 5 years 166 days, earlier CM of Delhi.
9. Pratibha Patil - first woman Governor, resigned 2007 to become President of India.
10. Prabha Rau and Margaret Alva are the other two women Governors; Justice Jagat Narain the first acting Governor.

11. Legislative Articles - 174 sessions, 175 message, 176 special address, 200 assent, 201 reservation, 213 ordinance.
12. Ordinance ceases six weeks after the House reassembles; some subjects need the President's prior instructions.
13. A Money Bill cannot be returned for reconsideration, and the House need not accept the Governor's suggestions.
14. Article 161 - no pardon of a death sentence, no jurisdiction over court martial; those are the President's under Article 72.
15. Article 163(2) - the Governor's own view on what is discretionary is final and non-justiciable; Article 361 gives immunity.
16. Discretion covers a 356 report, reserving a Bill, choosing a CM in a hung House, dismissing a defeated ministry.
17. RPSC and Advocate General appointments are made by the Governor but on ministerial advice - not discretion.
18. President's Rule in Rajasthan four times - 1967, 1977, 1980, 1992-93; Shekhawat displaced twice.
19. The 1992-93 spell of about 354 days is the longest; the Assembly is dissolved or suspended during 356.
20. Governor as of September 2026 - Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde, in office since 31 July 2024.